

“A unique, thorough collection of interesting blog articles”

Tuxmachines

www.tuxmachines.org

Neat! The news collection website run by a journalist, Tuxmachines is a catch-all, for everybody from newbies to codies, and everyone in between. Check out how-tos, industry trends, bouquets and brickbats, migration sagas and hardware/software reviews—what you'll love about Tuxmachines is its variety.

Tuxmachines pulls in articles from both pro and amateur sites. Often, the amateur content is more frank, entertaining and outspoken. Here you'll get serious articles as well as those written by hobbyists, most of which probably won't appear on *LinuxToday* or other pro sources. You'll also find original distro reviews—the website creator is a regular distro nut, like you and me. Oh, another thing: the name apart, Tuxmachines also covers BSD and other OSs like Syllable. Perhaps its name ought to be Fossmachines then? :-)

Tuxmachines has an admirable editorial stance of objectivity: nothing is suppressed, no matter how complimentary or otherwise. It is never fanatical or one-



Tuxmachines

sided on any topic.

Tuxmachines, itself being a hobbyist project, has a few issues. Its format is not pretty, and the layout could be better (strictly IMO). Basically, it's a blog run by one person, and yet it can hold its own alongside several pro sites. Launched in 2004, this is one of the few websites that adds content several times a day. It is possibly the best mining source for amateur or private content—to read of personal experiences with FOSS, and to discover new how-tos and applications.

The website can be slow sometimes—it is among the more popular reads in the FOSS world. Worth a daily visit, folks!

“Scoops for OS industry professionals”

OSNews

www.osnews.com

Not specifically a FOSS site, OSNews collects stories on all the major and hobbyist operating systems. It focuses on the industry rather than on the technology, and follows current industry trends (like Ogg vs Flash; Apple vs Google; Microsoft vs everybody and H.264 vs Theora kind of stories) in a more sustained manner than most media. If you're an OS industry professional, whether programmer, marketing person or strategist (or journalist!), you should find OSNews pertinent. Its coverage is day-to-day, detailed and simple. It does summary and collation well, frequently guided by its readers. Its coverage of the SCO saga was among the best on the Web.

OSNews also covers technology that impacts OS growth: for instance, it previews newly developed tablet technology, or covers case studies of embedded Linux, ARM implementations, etc.

By definition, OSNews will rarely shy away from controversy. It has apparently been accused of being pro-



OSNews

Microsoft, pro-Linux, and pro-Apple—all at the same time! I don't know what to conclude from this, except that the coverage seems well-balanced.

OSNews lovingly covers non-mainstream operating systems such as Syllable, Haiku, ReactOS and AROS. It is a welcome change for a mainstream medium to cover the small projects—remember, Linux was once small too.

Started in 1997, OSNews has a refined and clean format with an aesthetic, sober and yet cheerful colour palette. It has a comments system with some social networking features available for registered users.

Politically, OSNews is a corporate entity, and seems to prefer the term 'Open Source' to 'Free Software', but it doesn't take sides, as such. Personally, I wish it would be more pro-FOSS; neutrality isn't always a virtue.